

Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP) for Ayurveda, Siddha and Unani (ASU) Drugs — Schedule T

Ministry of AYUSH · Guideline · 2021

SECTION 1 — LEGAL BASIS

Schedule T of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945, prescribes Good Manufacturing Practices for units manufacturing Ayurvedic, Siddha and Unani (ASU) drugs in India. Compliance with Schedule T is mandatory for grant and renewal of a manufacturing licence under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940.

SECTION 2 — INFRASTRUCTURE REQUIREMENTS

Manufacturing premises must provide:

- Adequate space (minimum area norms vary by dosage form) separated into distinct areas for raw material storage, processing, packing, and finished goods storage.
- Proper ventilation, lighting, and protection from contamination, including pest control measures.
- Dedicated quality control laboratory with equipment appropriate to the dosage forms manufactured (e.g. disintegration testers for tablets, viscometers for liquid preparations).

SECTION 3 — RAW MATERIAL AND PROCESS CONTROLS

- Raw materials (herbs, minerals, metals, animal-origin substances) must be procured against defined specifications, with authenticity testing (macroscopic/microscopic/chemical) prior to use.
- Batch manufacturing records must document each stage of processing, including heavy metal and microbial testing where applicable.
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) are required for all critical processes: cleaning, weighing, extraction, drying, and packing.

SECTION 4 — QUALITY CONTROL AND TESTING

Finished products must be tested against pharmacopoeial standards (Ayurvedic Pharmacopoeia of India / Unani Pharmacopoeia of India / Siddha Pharmacopoeia, as applicable) or, in their absence, in-house specifications, covering:

- Identity and assay of key marker compounds.
- Heavy metal limits (lead, arsenic, mercury, cadmium).
- Microbial load and absence of specified pathogens.
- Pesticide residue limits, where relevant to plant-derived ingredients.

SECTION 5 — LICENSING — FORM 24D / FORM 25D

- Form 24D: Licence to manufacture ASU drugs for sale/distribution (loan/contract manufacturing arrangements have specific additional conditions).
- Form 25D: Licence to manufacture ASU drugs for purposes of examination, test, and analysis (not for sale).
- Applications are made to the State Licensing Authority, accompanied by a site master file, list of products, and proof of GMP compliance (self-certification is followed by periodic inspection).

SECTION 6 — CoPP (CERTIFICATE OF PHARMACEUTICAL PRODUCT)

Manufacturers seeking to export ASU products, particularly to markets that require WHO-GMP-style documentation, may apply for a Certificate of Pharmaceutical Product from the State Licensing Authority once GMP compliance and product registration are established.

DISCLAIMER: General summary for informational/demo purposes; verify current requirements against the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945 (as amended) and your State Licensing Authority's current procedure.